

Your recordings that then captured on the DAW software. Most of these offer multi track recording capabilities. This means that several artists could be performing at the same time and each one could have a isolated track of only their performance provided they each have mic to themselves. What's recorded is represented as a wave form. These waveforms are a visual representation of the sound and you can tell if what you've just recorded was good or bad.

Once you've recorded everything, it's time to mix them. Mixing is as much an art as it is a science. Mixing is what makes the track sound like what you want it to sound. Mixing involves playing with levels on different tracks so that it sounds good and doesn't sound like a whole lot of noise.

Mixing also involves the use of filters to add definition to the sound. Certain frequencies could be clipped, others could be enhanced, some lines could be given an effect and knowing how to do this and how sound will behave is where the science comes in.

The final step is mastering. The mixer mixes the entire deluge of tracks down to one and gives the master one track. What happens next is shrouded in mystery and each master has his own style. While some say that mastering is a hardware intensive job, others believe the same song is performed once again by angels and bunnies and the sound is then washed in the tears of the manicore.



I'm your pop filter baby!

It is widely agreed that the mastering process is best done with analogue equipment and involves the use of noise cutters, compressors, equalisers and a lot of expensive equipment. The equipment that some use are so expensive that you can buy a house with that kind of money.

While a lot about mastering is a little nebulous, what we do know is that But one thing we're certain of is that "it's the final creative stage when it comes to audio editing," says Kuber Sharma, a sound engineer/ music producer/ musician based out of Mumbai. The purpose of mastering is